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Rose Red

The entire town was in a festive mood. It was an October autumn, in the small town of Auterwitz, Germany, in 1872, and the town was celebrating the successful harvest with a grand feast in the spacious town square. The middle aged men and women of the town danced happily with each other, while the older people of the town conversed and laughed among themselves, and the children ran about.

As the commotion continued, a little boy spotted something in the distance coming toward them. He showed the other boys what he saw, and they all turned to inspect. Soon, the mothers and fathers of the town spotted what the boys were looking at, and they also stopped to look. When the figures were close enough to the town, one of the townspeople figured out that there were five priests, dressed in white robes, with red scarves. When the priests entered the town, they explained that they were only spreading the gospel, and wanted to attend the town's festival. They explained they were tired, had been wandering the forest for days, and thought it good to take a rest.

Rest may have not been the only thing on their minds. The lead priest of the group, by the name of Sebastian, with blue eyes, a stubbly, rough beard, and short, graying brown hair, eyed a young woman coming into town, and she returned the feeling for him also. After making his entrance, Sebastian immediately went to talk to the young woman. She told him her name was Maria. She had long, brown hair, and a red dress with white lace stitched on it. She was the prettiest woman Sebastian had ever laid eyes upon. They talked, danced, and ate together for a

while, until it got late, when Maria decided it was time to retire for the night. Sebastian told her he would retire with the other priests, but she whispered in his ear that she hoped he would come with her. A smile grew on his face, and he told her that he would retire with her.

Maria's parents were staying the night at their friend's house because of the grand festival, and she had the house to herself. Sebastian and Maria walked to the house talking about the merriments of life. When they arrived at the house, they retired to bed. As Sebastian lay beside Maria, he turned to her, and voiced his thoughts. He knew Maria's parents would not approve, as well as the church. Maria, with a fiery glow in her eyes, told Sebastian to kill her parents. Sebastian's face grew ice cold. He knew it would be a sin to do so, yet for a fleeting moment, he considered it. He looked into her eyes and smiled.

Just then, they both heard rustling of the fall leaves outside of the house. Maria jumped out of the bed, ran to the windows, and looked out of it to see what was coming. Her mouth dropped open. To her disbelief, her parents were trudging to the house in the dead of night. She immediately turned to Sebastian, and told him to do something. Sebastian paused for a second, then told Maria to get back into bed. He jumped from the bed, and left the room.

Maria lay in bed, trembling under the covers, and frightened by what would happen if her parents discovered that a strange man was in their house, alone with their daughter. She heard her parents open the door, and could hear the creaking of the wooden floor beneath their feet. Soon after, she heard the shrillest scream she had ever. It was her mother, in shock of the surprise of a stranger in the house. Sebastian had surprised them both by popping out from the hallway. He immediately plunged a knife into the man's stomach. The man fell over, bleeding on the cold floor. Frightened, Maria's mother was unable to move. Sebastian moved closer to her, and struck at her with the knife. She rolled out of the way, but fell and hit her head on a table, and was knocked out cold. Like an animal, Sebastian turned to the unconscious woman,

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and sank the knife into her chest many times over. Covered in blood, he rose from the lifeless

body, and went back to Maria's room.

When Maria saw that Sebastian was covered in blood, she screamed. Sebastian's heart grew cold as Maria leaped from the bed, and she ran out of the house. She screamed into the town that there was a murderer in her house. Sebastian panicked, as he did not know what to do. The townspeople awoke from their slumber, and came outside to see what the commotion was. When they realized the extent of what Maria was saying, their blood became cold. The peaceful town of Auterwitz was no longer as safe as they thought. The strong men of the town rushed towards Maria's house in hopes to catch the killer. When they opened the door to the house, they discovered the horrid crime that was just committed. The fresh stain of blood was splattered across the floor. They searched the house, until they found Sebastian, huddling in a corner of a closet. They pulled him out of his cowering position, drug him outside, and started to beat him ferociously. At this time, the entire town was outside of their houses, gathering around, and witnessing the event that was taking place. The men drug Sebastian to the noose, and put the rope around his neck. There was a desperate look on Sebastian's face as the men slowly lowered the floor, and he began to struggle. He could feel the ground beneath his feet slowly move away, and he could feel his neck growing tighter. He struggled to get free, but soon gave up. He looked up at the townspeople, and the world slowly faded away.